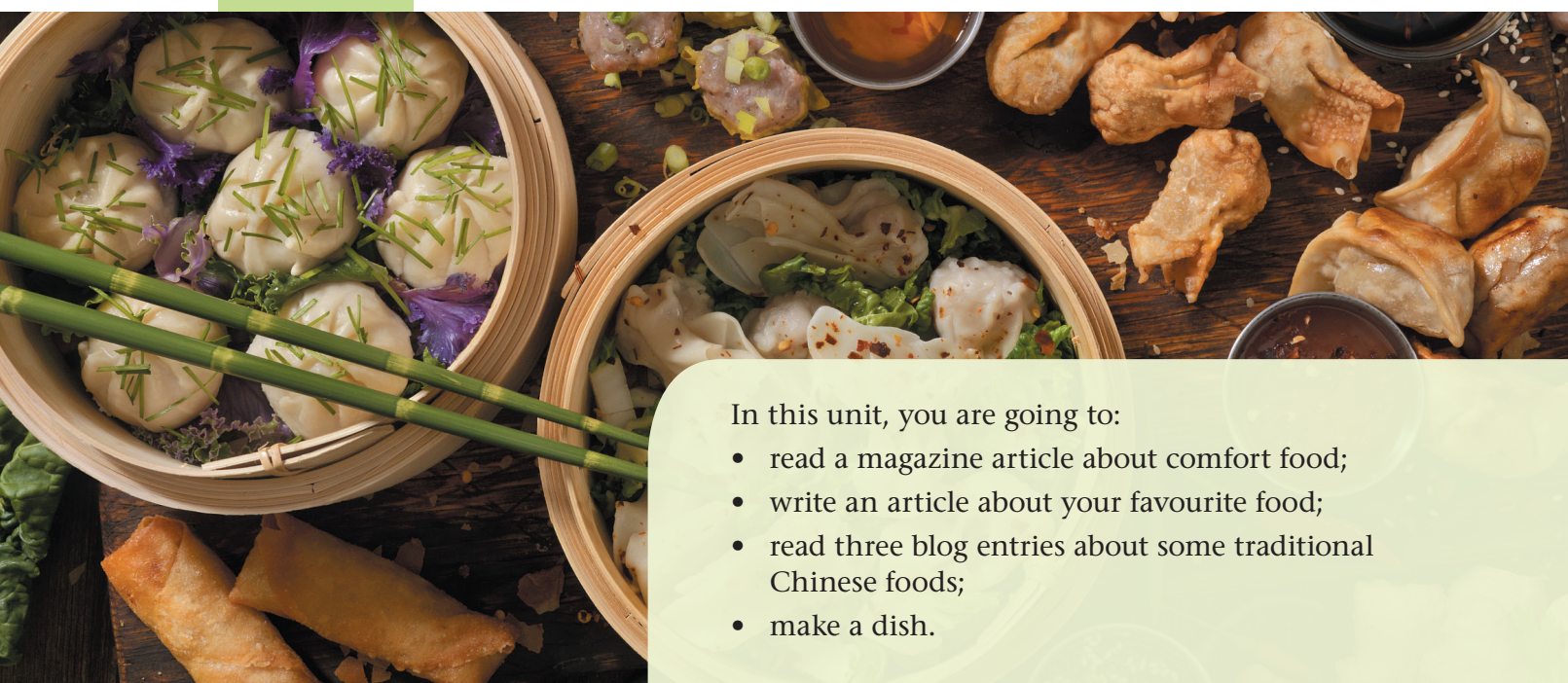


UNIT 1

Food matters

Food is as fundamental to man as the people are to the state.

—Chen Shou



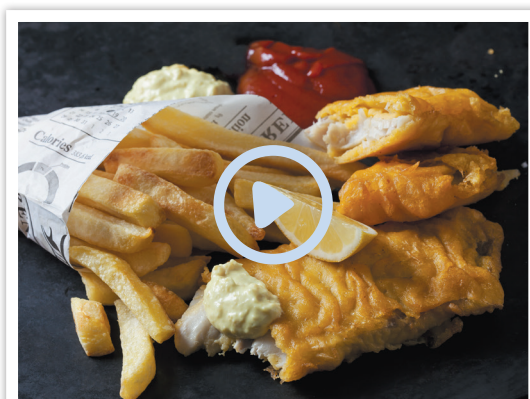
In this unit, you are going to:

- read a magazine article about comfort food;
- write an article about your favourite food;
- read three blog entries about some traditional Chinese foods;
- make a dish.

Welcome to the unit



Each country has its typical food. Watch the video and finish the following exercises.



- Fish and chips from the UK consists of deep-fried fish and _____ chips.
- Sushi from Japan comes in _____ and is very popular partly because of its freshness and convenience.
- A taco, a traditional Mexican dish, is made up of a _____ or wheat pancake rolled around a filling.
- Pasta from Italy is typically made from flour, water and sometimes _____.

- 1 Which of the dishes in the video would you like to try most? Why?
- 2 What do you think is the most typical Chinese food?

Reading



Food keeps us healthy and energetic. It can also do more than that. The article below, from a food magazine, discusses the idea of comfort food. Before you read the article, think about the following questions:

- What do you think the article will talk about according to the title?
- What foods can have an impact on your feelings?



Whenever I feel lonely, I have a secret recipe that never fails: rice, milk and sugar, cooked low and slow. No matter how bad my mood is, that perfect combination is always enough to lift my spirits. Sometimes the smell alone can do the trick, not to mention the lovely creamy flavour, which works like a time machine immediately
5 transporting me back to my sunny childhood. With pleasure, I remember the lazy Sunday afternoons I used to spend in the warmth of my grandma's flat, listening to her wonderful stories and greedily eating bowl after bowl of her delicious rice pudding. I take my time over every spoonful, gently rolling the silky dessert around my mouth and enjoying the perfect marriage of rice and milk. Before I know it, I'm
10 happy again.

My experience with rice pudding illustrates the unique power of "comfort food". In its broadest sense, comfort food refers to any food that makes us feel better. In this article, we will talk about a particular type of comfort food whose power mainly lies in the associations it calls to mind. It often makes up for bad feelings by
15 helping us recall happy memories of the people, things or places we love.

Our comfort foods are highly individual. They vary from person to person, depending on our own unique experiences that have shaped our lives. If we grow

up eating certain foods in our family, then those foods tend to be linked with positive emotions. For example, we often connect chicken soup with a happy
20 childhood and its flavour becomes tied up with the feeling of being taken care of. When we eat it again, we unlock memories of a time when we were loved and looked after, and this cheers us up.

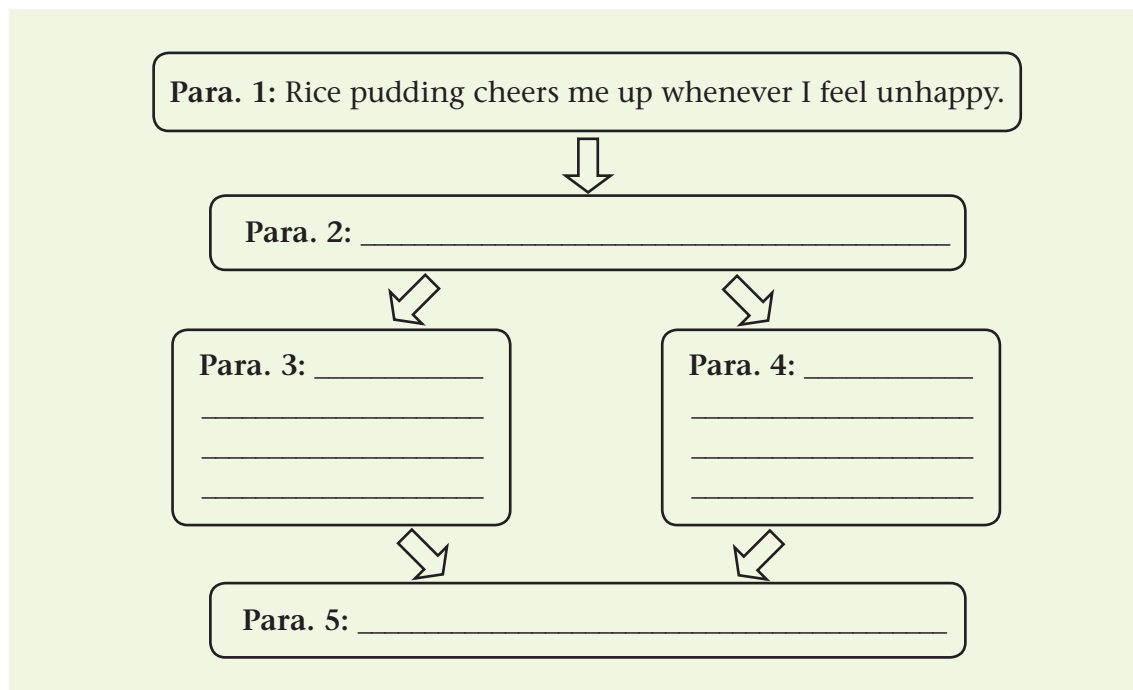
The feeling of happiness and sense of belonging can become particularly important for people who move away from their home country. According to some food
25 experts, there are some aspects of culture that people will lose right away, but with food, there are more opportunities to connect to memory, family and place. It is hardest to give up the food that you grow up with. Of course, each person's comfort food largely depends on where they come from—for a Chinese it might be a plate of dumplings with a saucer of vinegar, and for a native of the UK it might
30 be the classic fish and chips, served hot, salty and sour. One mouthful of comfort food takes us back to our cultural roots, giving us the “taste of home” that we cry out for and relieving feelings of homesickness.

That's certainly true for me. Comfort food tastes good and by building an emotional bond with our happy memories, always makes us feel good. It isn't just a
35 bowl of noodles or chicken soup. It's food for the soul.



A Understanding the text

A1 Read the article and complete the chart below with the main idea of each paragraph.



A2 Read the article again carefully and answer the following questions.

1 What does the author compare the flavour of the rice pudding to in the first paragraph?

2 What is comfort food in its broadest sense?

3 According to the third paragraph, how does comfort food such as chicken soup cheer us up?

4 For people who move away from their home country, what largely determines their comfort food?

Tip

Understanding definitions in a text

In some texts definitions are given to key concepts with such expressions as *refer to*. In some cases, *in a broad sense* or *in a narrow sense* is used to make the definition more accurate.

A3 In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1 How does the author introduce the topic of comfort food? What do you think of this technique?

2 What foods can remind you of your happy memories? Describe the memories they recall.

3 In your opinion, is there any difference between one's comfort food and favourite food? Give your reasons.

B Building your language

B1 The passage below is about a different kind of comfort food. Complete the passage with the correct forms of the words and phrases in the box below.

greedily
mood

emotion
dessert

link
relieve

cry out for
do the trick

When we are in low spirits, we may (1) _____ things that give us comfort and a sense of security. Since it brings back happy memories of the past or offers an opportunity to connect with our home culture, comfort food can often (2) _____. However, there is another type of comfort food, which generates positive (3) _____ in a different way. Food high in calories may also make us feel better. As (4) _____ like cakes are digested, blood sugar levels can go up quickly. As a result, we will be in a better (5) _____ after eating the comfort food. However, the sharp increase in blood sugar will cause the body to produce a special chemical to remove it. When the chemical lowers blood sugar levels, we are likely to feel sad again and will (6) _____ eat more comfort food. There is then the danger of entering a cycle of highs and lows where more and more comfort food, high in carbohydrates, needs to be eaten. This (7) _____ with health problems like being overweight.

Comfort food is an important tool in helping us (8) _____ tension and feel good about ourselves. However, be aware of the hidden dangers of high-calorie comfort food!

B2 The article uses several phrasal verbs with “up”. Complete the sentences with the correct forms of the phrasal verbs in the left box. There are two phrasal verbs you do NOT need to use. Then think of more phrasal verbs with “up”.

cheer up
make up for
give up
take up
keep up
set up
show up

- 1 I find it hard to _____ my energy right after lunch.
- 2 I waited for half an hour, but he never _____.
- 3 Let's help _____ the stage for the show.
- 4 Have you _____ any new hobbies recently?
- 5 The good days can _____ the bad ones.

B3 The article uses different phrases to express “to make sb think of sth” and “to make sb feel better”. Find these expressions in the article and improve the sentences below by varying the language.

Learn this It is important to vary your language in your writing so that readers do not get bored. To achieve this, you can use words and phrases with similar meanings.

Breakfast is an important meal and what people eat for breakfast is quite different. People from different places and with different eating habits tend to eat different things for breakfast.

Grammar and usage

To-infinitives as subjects and predicatives

A Exploring the rules

Below is a blog entry about eating out and eating at home. Find the sentences that use to-infinitives as subjects or predicatives and fill in the table below. The first ones have been done for you.

Not that long ago, my first thought at mealtimes was to eat at a restaurant. I was eager to try new restaurants. To eat out was also a social activity, allowing me to enhance the relationship with my friends. I often ate out until last month, when I came across a cooking app. There are a variety of recipes in the app to choose from. They are uploaded by users, and offer detailed instructions so that others can follow them step by step. Most of the recipes include photos or videos, which are very useful for beginners. When I picked a popular recipe and gave it a try, I discovered that it was not that difficult to make a simple and tasty dish. In the last few weeks, I've thrown myself into home cooking, from boiling noodles in the pot to frying steak in the pan. I hardly eat out any more. Not only is cooking at home cheaper, but I can cook exactly what I want. It's healthier too. No wonder people say nothing beats home cooking!

Now I am good at cooking a couple of dishes. My plan is to invite my friends over at the weekend to show them my new-found skills. I hope that they will like my cooking!

To-infinitives as subjects	To eat out was also a social activity, ...
To-infinitives as predicatives	..., my first thought at mealtimes was to eat at a restaurant.

Working out the rules

- When the *to*-infinitive is used as a subject, we usually use the preparatory subject (1) _____ at the beginning of the sentence.
- The *to*-infinitive can also be used as a predicative. It usually comes after the verb (2) _____.

👉 Grammar notes → page 94

B Applying the rules

B1 Rewrite the following sentences using to-infinitives according to the requirements in the brackets.

- 1 The next dish that the cook will prepare is Kung Pao Chicken. (attributive)

- 2 The preparation of home-cooked meals is easy and enjoyable. (subject)

- 3 Her dream is that she will open a restaurant some day. (predicative)

- 4 We will put the potatoes in the pot first in order that they will be cooked quickly. (adverbial of purpose)

- 5 I consider the Soup of the Day as the best option on the menu. (object complement)

B2 Below is a lifestyle magazine article. Complete the article with the correct forms of the verbs in the brackets.

As long as you are not afraid of heights, you will be impressed by Sky Buffet, the latest restaurant in the city centre. (1) _____ (locate) at the top of Tower 88, it gives you an amazing view of the bay. Better still, its entire seating area turns slowly and it is enjoyable (2) _____ (see) the scenery outside while having your meal. Since it takes about an hour (3) _____ (turn) the full 360 degrees, you are unlikely to get bored with the scenery. If you want to get the most wonderful views, your best bet is (4) _____ (sit) by the window an hour before sunset and watch how the sky changes colours. The atmosphere is lively and modern, with its walls (5) _____ (paint) white and light blue. Sky Buffet serves a menu full of eye-catching Asian dishes, (6) _____ (range) from Chinese food to Japanese food. It will be a good idea (7) _____ (invite) your family and friends over for dinner. Sky Buffet is considered by many locals (8) _____ (be) the perfect location for a special occasion.

B3 Imagine your friend has taken you out to dinner at Sky Buffet. Write a thank-you note to your friend, offering to return the favour by inviting him or her to your home for dinner next weekend. Remember to use to-infinitives. Use the expressions below to help you.

Expressions

I am writing to ...

It was so kind of you to ...

It was wonderful to ...

I have always wanted to ...

I would like/love to ...

My plan is to ...

Integrated skills

Introducing your favourite food

A Jake's teacher, Mr Guan, is making an announcement about the school Food Festival. Listen and finish the exercises below.



A1 Listen to the announcement and decide whether the following statements are true (**T**) or false (**F**).

- 1 The first school Food Festival took place last year. T / F
- 2 This year's Food Festival will be held on 15 March. T / F
- 3 Students can learn about food from many different countries at the Food Festival. T / F
- 4 Changes can be made to the programme. T / F
- 5 The writing competition will begin on the day of the Food Festival. T / F



A2 Listen to the announcement again and complete the notes below.

Events at the Food Festival

Cooking classes

Learn how to make different food, e.g. (1) _____

Food stands

- Present different kinds of food for students to try
- Think of (2) _____ and make some food according to it
- Decorate your food stands to (3) _____ as many people as possible

A writing competition

- The article should be of no less than (4) _____.
- You should tell us what your favourite food is and (5) _____ more than other foods.
- You should hand in the article before (6) _____.

B Jake and his friend Amy have written about their favourite foods for the competition. Read their articles and pay attention to the descriptions of food.

Mooncakes: a taste that is out of this world!

By Jake Zhao

Of all the foods I have ever tried, the mooncake is my favourite. There are many versions of mooncakes from different places around China. They have a variety of fillings and among them I love the sweet red bean filling best. I remember trying my first mooncake with my family when I was very little. We sat outside in my grandparents' yard while the full moon shone above us. It was a very special moment. My elderly grandmother still bakes mooncakes for the whole family every year. She can turn the flour and red beans into wonderful mooncakes like magic. When she places them on the table, they look adorable—small, round and shiny golden-brown. The delicious smell soon reaches my nose and my mouth starts to water. When I pick up a mooncake, it feels warm and heavy in my hand. As I take each bite, the sweet and mild flavour of the red bean filling slowly fills my mouth. The mooncake is always my favourite because of its satisfying taste that is out of this world and the happy memories it brings to mind.



Tiramisu cheers me up

By Amy Xu

My favourite food is a popular Italian dessert called tiramisu. I first tried it about two years ago, when I visited a bakery with my parents. Each spoonful of this amazing dessert is a light, creamy experience to remember. There are three layers of the cake and the cheese is between the layers, making the dessert feel soft and smooth. There is also a bitter taste of coffee but this flavour is not very strong. Tiramisu does not look very attractive—it's brown, because of the coffee and dark chocolate, and white, because of the cream and cheese—but all these ingredients make it taste delicious! Since I tried it for the first time, tiramisu has become my favourite dessert. I have also learnt that the name tiramisu means “cheer me up” in Italian. Whenever I feel unhappy, I eat this dessert and it does make me feel better!



C In pairs, talk about your favourite food. Use the following questions to help you.

- What is your favourite food?
- Why do you like it? (How it looks, smells, tastes and feels in your mouth, how you associate it with a particular experience, etc.)

Tip

Using rhetorical questions in conversation

A rhetorical question is a figure of speech in the form of a question that is asked to emphasize a point or to express feelings and attitudes. For example, when you ask "How can I forget such a tasty dish?", you are actually emphasizing that you always remember the dish.

D Write an article about your favourite food. Use your ideas from part C and the information in parts A and B to help you.

Planning your writing

- **Learning about the text type**

An article about your favourite food is a piece of descriptive writing which can create a vivid picture in readers' minds through plenty of sensory details.

- **Learning about the structure**

When writing an article about your favourite food, you can follow the structure below:

- State clearly what your favourite food is.
- Mention your experiences of tasting it, especially for the first time.
- Describe the characteristics of the food, such as its appearance, smell, taste and way of cooking.

- **Learning about the language**

When you describe food, you can use adjectives to create an image of the food in the mind of the reader. Adjectives commonly used to describe food include *smelly, bitter, sweet, salty, juicy, creamy, silky, smooth, soft, crisp*, etc.

Checking your writing

Remember to check your writing after you finish and exchange drafts between you and your partner. Pay attention to the following aspects:

- | | | |
|--|--|------------------------------------|
| ☐ Punctuation | ☐ Spelling | ☐ Grammar |
| ☐ Choice of words | ☐ Style (formal/informal) | ☐ Structure |

Self-review

- Do you use adjectives to describe the food? Is your description vivid enough?
- What changes can you make to improve your writing?

Peer review

- Does your partner think there are enough sensory details in your writing?
- Which part does your partner find most interesting?

Extended reading



Read the following entries from the blog of a food critic who is eating his way through traditional Chinese foods.

Eating in China

7 March, Sichuan hot pot

The mouth-watering hot pots of Sichuan are as famous overseas as they are in China, and the hot flavour is enough to heat up a cold midwinter evening or to let loose rivers of sweat on a summer afternoon. I gave it my first
5 try last night, together with a few local friends. As the soup bubbled slowly over a gas burner in the middle of the table, its surface was covered with a beautiful layer of chillies, Sichuan peppers, spring onions and red oil. Slowly at first, and then faster and faster, we tipped plates of fresh meat, fish and
10 vegetables into the pot. The hot flavour quickened our laughter and conversation, making the meal the perfect way to relax with friends.



Sichuan hot pots are perfect for the damp, foggy climate in which they were invented. They are believed to have started off in the late Qing Dynasty as a way for boatmen on the Yangtze River to keep warm during the cold and wet winters.

15 In the beginning, the delicious dish was made simply by boiling vegetables, chillies and Sichuan peppers in water. Over time, it has expanded to include multiple options of soups, vegetables, meats and sauces, appealing to people of different tastes. What I love best about Sichuan hot pots is that they offer a great opportunity to socialize with friends since a meal can last for hours. I instantly
20 became a big fan of Sichuan hot pots and I'll soon be back for more!

12 August, Nanjing salted duck

Salted duck is Nanjing's most famous food export. Served plain in thin, white slices, the meat is juicy and salty. Each Nanjing salted duck takes several days to

prepare, and the process includes salting, drying, boiling
25 and cooling. As I finished my first helping on a recent
afternoon in Nanjing, my host, Chef Zhang, told me a
little more about the dish.



The countryside around Nanjing has been famous for
its ducks for centuries; its countless waterways make the area perfect for raising
30 waterbirds. A local history book from the late Qing Dynasty praised salted duck in
particular, saying it was without equal. Traditionally, duck is considered to have
cooling properties, so it is appropriate for the hot summer months. Nowadays,
people eat salted duck all year round and it is estimated that tens of thousands of
ducks are consumed every day in Nanjing! It definitely hit the spot when I tried it,
35 and it has become one of my personal favourites.

8 December, Cantonese dim sum

In Guangzhou, morning tea is such an essential part of the daily routine that “Have
you had your tea?” has become the local version of “Good morning.” Though
teahouses have been common in China since the Tang Dynasty, the Cantonese
40 innovation of the mid-19th century was to serve tea
together with a variety of light dishes, or dim sum. The
concept took off, and today Guangzhou’s restaurants
stimulate customers’ appetite with over a thousand
offerings, each more delicate and delicious than the last.



45 The Cantonese do not hurry over their breakfasts, as I found when I visited a
restaurant in Guangzhou’s old city centre this morning. The emphasis is rather
on conversation about business, family or pleasure, and locals can spend hours
together chatting, drinking tea and working their way through the menu. From
beef balls to rice noodle rolls, there are various dishes that have been baked, boiled,
50 steamed or fried. A single visit is not enough to appreciate everything, and I have a
long list of dim sum I still need to try.

A Write a summary of each of the three traditional Chinese foods.

B What dish is popular in your hometown? Introduce it to a foreign traveller. Explain its popularity, history and features.

Project

Making a dish

A As a class, discuss dishes from around the world or new dishes you would like to create. Then in groups, choose a dish to research.

B As a group, research the recipe for your chosen dish. Use the example below to help you.

Dumplings

Main ingredients

500 grams of meat, Chinese cabbage, dumpling wrappers

Instructions

- Mix together the meat and the Chinese cabbage.
- Fill the dumpling wrappers with the mixture. Stick the edges of the dumpling wrappers together.
- Boil the dumplings.
- Set the cooked dumplings on a plate and serve with vinegar.

Dos

- Before mixing, salt the Chinese cabbage, let it rest for 15 minutes and press out extra water.
- Use water to stick the edges together if necessary.

Don'ts

- Don't put the dumplings into the water when it is not boiling.
- Don't overfill the dumplings, or they will fall apart when you boil them.



C As a group, make a video or take some photos of how you make the dish. Use the example to help you. Then present your video or photos to the rest of the class.



Assessment

Answer the following questions to assess your performance. Then work in groups and exchange your answers with your partners.

- 1 Which key characteristics of comfort food can you identify?
- 2 What do you think of your writing about your favourite food? List 2 or 3 sentences that you are the most satisfied with.
- 3 What can you learn from the blog entries to help you introduce a popular dish in your hometown?
- 4 Did you have any difficulty doing the project of this unit? If yes, what was it?
- 5 What new words have you learnt from this unit? List some of them. *
- 6 What grammar have you learnt from this unit? Make a sentence with the grammar. *
- 7 What tips have you learnt from this unit? Make a list of them.
- 8 How are you going to improve your overall performance? Make an action plan.

* Assess your learning of vocabulary and grammar by doing language practice on pages 57–58.

Further study



Ratatouille is an animated film about Remy, a young rat who dreams of becoming a chef in a famous restaurant. His dream is encouraged by the restaurant's original owner, who believes that anyone can cook, but only the fearless can be great. Watch this film and join in Remy's food adventures.



“What Happens in Your Brain When You Taste Food” is a video talk given by neuroscientist Camilla Arndal Andersen. She reveals surprising information about how our brains “taste” food and hopes that her discoveries can help create healthier foods without sacrificing taste. Watch the video talk to find out more about her fascinating research.



UNIT 2

The universal language

*Music is the utmost pleasure in life; music is the clear spring of life;
music is the furnace of temperamental refinement.*

—Xian Xinghai



In this unit, you are going to:

- read two emails by exchange students about their experiences of discovering new music;
- write an article about your favourite singer or band;
- read a magazine article about a classical musician;
- make a profile of an English song.

Welcome to the unit

Musical instruments come in a wide range of types. Read the posters below about two important musical instruments and the musicians, and discuss the following questions in pairs.

Erhu

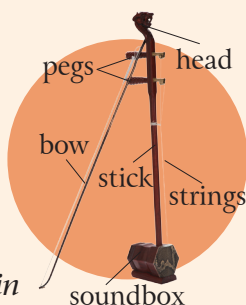
—Invented in China in the Tang Dynasty

Hua Yanjun

- Also known as A Bing, a blind *erhu* artist
- Famous for *Moonlight on the Second Spring*

Liu Tianhua

- Improved the *erhu* instrument and its performing techniques
- Famous for *Moon Night* and *Birdsong over Empty Mountain*



Piano

—Invented in Italy in the early 18th century

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart

- An Austrian composer
- Famous for *Symphony No. 41* (the *Jupiter Symphony*) and *Piano Concerto No. 23*

Frédéric François Chopin

- A Polish composer and pianist
- Famous for the *Minute Waltz*



- 1 Search online for the pieces of music mentioned in the posters. How do you feel when listening to them?
- 2 What other musical instruments and famous musical pieces or musicians do you know about?

Reading



A great way to learn about a new culture is through its music. The emails below are written by two exchange students who are discovering new music in their host countries. Before you read the emails, think about the following questions:

- What information do you think the emails contain according to the subjects?
- Have you watched a music performance live or on TV? What was it like?

Understanding culture through music

 Send	From	Alice Duncan
	To	Lucy Becker
	Subject	<i>Butterfly Lovers</i>

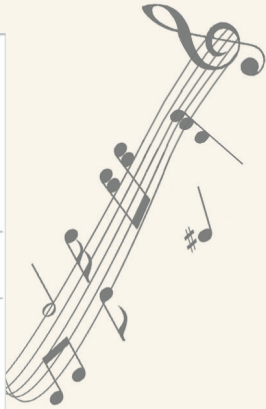
Hi Lucy,

So glad to get your email. I hope everything is fine with you. Last night, I watched a performance of *Butterfly Lovers*, a beautiful violin concerto composed by He Zhanhao and Chen Gang. It's a piece that really deserves to be heard.

The music took me through the twists and turns of a classic story about a young couple torn apart by their families. When the two lovers, Liang Shanbo and Zhu Yingtai, first meet, the music is light and pleasant, as if whispering to the audience. It is followed by a fast and cheerful section which represents their three happy years of school. Then the music gets dramatic with heavier notes and that is when the lovers are separated because Zhu's father forces her to marry another man. Angry and sad, Liang falls sick and dies. Zhu weeps bitterly over the loss of her love. Overcome with sorrow, she jumps into his grave. Finally, during the most exciting part, the music takes a softer turn and ends on a bittersweet note, telling us how the couple transform into butterflies and fly away to be together forever. It is an amazing journey!

Butterfly Lovers combines Chinese and Western musical elements: it is played on Western instruments such as the violin, but more significantly, much of the music has its roots in Chinese Yue Opera. This unique combination has made me realize that music is indeed a universal language. You should definitely listen to *Butterfly Lovers*—I bet you'll like it!

All the best,
Alice



To Stephen Lin ✕

From Harry Yu ✕

Subject Country music ✕

Send | A |  |  |  |  | ▾

Dear Stephen,

Life here in Nashville is as interesting as I thought it would be. My host family are big fans of country music, so I can always rely on them to introduce me to some great songs. I love learning about country music and I keep asking them questions about it all the time!

It turns out that country music became popular right here in the south of America in the 1940s and then spread across the nation. It grew out of such music types as the blues and folk music, so the musicians use many similar instruments, such as the guitar. The tunes are easy to sing, and the lyrics often leave you deep in thought. Most of the songs are about hardship and heartbreak, but also about hope—with plenty of humour thrown in for good measure. You can feel an emotional connection between you and the musicians.

Country music shows the peaceful green fields and simple life of the countryside. Obviously I don't know what it's truly like to grow up in rural America, but the masters of country music, like John Denver, can make you feel like you're there. The simple tunes and beautiful natural images are often very suggestive of countryside surroundings:

Almost heaven, West Virginia
Blue Ridge Mountains, Shenandoah River
Life is old there, older than the trees
Younger than the mountains, growing like a breeze
(From "Take Me Home, Country Roads" by John Denver)

Why don't you try to listen to some great country music? I guarantee you'll enjoy it!

Best wishes,
Harry

A Understanding the text

A1 Read the emails and write down the main idea of each paragraph.

Alice's email

Para. 1: I watched a performance of *Butterfly Lovers* last night.

Para. 2: _____

Para. 3: _____

Harry's email

Para. 1: _____

Para. 2: _____

Para. 3: _____

Para. 4: You should listen to some country music.

A2 Read the emails again carefully and complete the notes below.

The violin concerto *Butterfly Lovers* takes us through the story of a young couple (1) _____. This beautiful piece of music expresses different moods—first light and pleasant, then (2) _____, next dramatic with heavier notes and finally bittersweet. The piece is a perfect combination of Chinese and Western musical elements—it is played on (3) _____ such as the violin but has its roots in Chinese Yue Opera.

Country music grew out of such music types as (4) _____. It became popular in the south of America in the 1940s and then spread across the nation. The tunes are easy to sing, and the lyrics often leave you deep in thought. Most of the songs are about (5) _____. Country music makes you think of the green fields and (6) _____.

A3 In pairs, discuss the following questions.

- 1 The violin concerto *Butterfly Lovers* is a combination of Chinese and Western musical elements. What do you think of this combination?
- 2 What can you know about rural America from “Take Me Home, Country Roads”?
- 3 Both Alice and Harry enjoyed their experiences of music from another culture. What do you think of Alice's opinion that “music is indeed a universal language”?

B Building your language

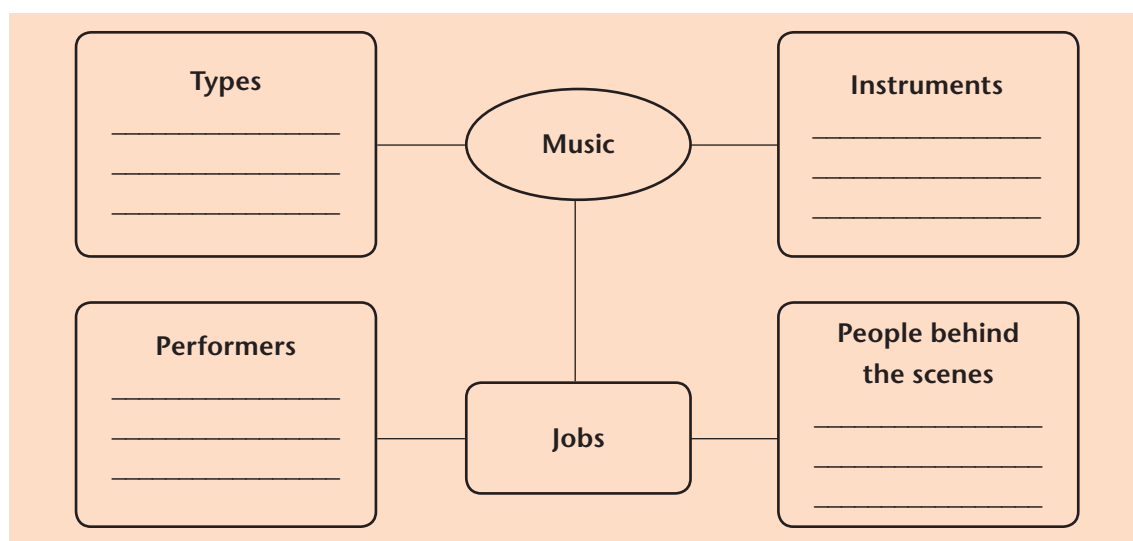
B1 The passage below is an introduction to a concert. Complete the passage with the correct forms of the words and phrases in the box below.

combine	overcome	transform	rely on
deserve	pleasant	guarantee	for good measure

Music has the power to (1) _____ our lives. To give the public more access to music, we will put on a series of free concerts. Music in different styles, from classical to jazz, will be played. You can (2) _____ us to show you some of the world's best-known works. The first of these concerts will be held in front of the arch in the downtown square at eight next Friday evening. Come and spend a (3) _____ evening with us!

At the concert you will enjoy the *Yellow River Piano Concerto*, one of China's greatest contributions to classical music. Like the violin concerto *Butterfly Lovers*, this piano concerto also (4) _____ Chinese and Western musical elements and is well received across the world. The musical piece, an adaptation of Xian Xinghai's *Yellow River Cantata*, tells how the Chinese people, led by the Communist Party of China, fought to (5) _____ the Japanese invaders. It consists of four movements: "The Song of the Yellow River Boatmen", "Ode to the Yellow River", "The Yellow River in Anger" and "Defend the Yellow River". The difficult piano solo in particular (6) _____ a mention. The concert will end with some short pieces of violin music (7) _____. We (8) _____ that you will enjoy this concert!

B2 The emails use some music-related vocabulary. Find the words in the emails and think of more on your own. Complete the chart with as many music-related words as you can.



B3 Alice uses personification when she describes the violin concerto *Butterfly Lovers*. Find the sentence and describe your favourite piece of music using personification.

Learn this With personification, a thing is described like a human being. This way, the description becomes more vivid and interesting, enabling the reader to look at the thing in a new and different way.

Grammar and usage

Verb-ing forms as subjects and objects

A Exploring the rules

Below is a story about a musician and his friend in ancient China. Find the sentences that use verb-ing forms as subjects or objects and fill in the table below. The first ones have been done for you.

In China's Spring and Autumn and Warring States periods, there lived a man named Boya, who was a master of the *qin*. Playing the *qin* was his life. He played so well that everyone enjoyed listening to his music and thought highly of his techniques. However, Boya believed no one could understand his music until he met Zhong Ziqi. Boya did not say anything before playing the *qin*, yet Zhong Ziqi was able to paint a picture of great mountain ranges in his mind. When Boya continued playing, Zhong Ziqi said he had heard the sound of a river flowing quickly. In fact, Boya had intended to call the piece *High Mountains and Flowing Water*. Having someone that really understood his music pleased Boya, who never got tired of sharing his music with Zhong Ziqi. The two soon became great friends and before going their separate ways, they agreed to meet at the Mid-Autumn Festival the next year. However, Zhong Ziqi failed to show up on that day. When Boya learnt about Zhong Ziqi's death, he was overcome with sorrow. He played *High Mountains and Flowing Water* in front of Zhong Ziqi's grave. After he finished playing the piece, he destroyed the *qin* and said, "Since the only person that understands my music is gone, it's no use keeping the *qin*."



Verb-ing forms as subjects	Playing the <i>qin</i> was his life.
Verb-ing forms as objects	... everyone enjoyed listening ...

Working out the rules

- When the verb-ing form is used as the subject of a sentence, we can sometimes use the preparatory subject *it* at the beginning of the sentence.
- The verb-ing form can also be used as the object of a (1) _____ or a (2) _____.

👉 Grammar notes → page 94

B Applying the rules

B1 Circle the mistakes and write down the correct forms in the blanks.

- 1 Listen to music is my favourite thing to do. _____
- 2 I really enjoy to read biographies of musicians. _____
- 3 It's no use try to play the violin if you're not going to give it your best shot. _____
- 4 Would you mind to teach me how to play the guitar? _____
- 5 These instruments were meant for play traditional Chinese music. _____

B2 Below is an article about the music sent into space. Complete the article with the correct forms of the verbs in the brackets.

If you have to choose music from the Earth to send into space, what music do you think is capable of (1) _____ (represent) mankind? The sound of the Chinese *qin* is one answer to this question. In 1977, two spacecraft called *Voyager 1* and *Voyager 2* were sent out (2) _____ (explore) the solar system. On both spacecraft, there is a selection of music from our planet. (3) _____ (send) music into outer space was the idea of the famous scientist Carl Sagan, who believed intelligent life existed on other planets. The music was intended as a universal language to greet intelligent life in space (if there is any). A group of scientists and artists got down to (4) _____ (choose) suitable music. Of course, they had trouble (5) _____ (select) which pieces of music to include. In the end, 27 different pieces of music (6) _____ (last) 90 minutes were put on the spacecraft. China is represented by a recording of Guan Pinghu (7) _____ (play) an ancient piece called *Flowing Water* on the Chinese instrument *qin*. It is said that Boya wrote it.

It took about 40 years for the *Voyager* spacecraft (8) _____ (enter) the space between the stars. We do not know what will happen in the end, but maybe the sound of the *qin* will one day be heard on a distant planet.

B3 In pairs, discuss how traditional Chinese music can be appreciated by a larger audience. Make a list of measures, using verb-ing forms as subjects or objects. Use the example below to help you.

Example

Holding music festivals will give the public more chances to appreciate traditional Chinese music.

Integrated skills

Introducing your favourite singer or band

A Jacky is listening to a school radio programme about music. Listen and finish the exercises below.



A1 Listen to the radio programme and decide whether the following statements are true (T) or false (F).

- | | | |
|---|--|-------|
| 1 | Hot Hits and Super Sounds is being broadcast for the first time. | T / F |
| 2 | The programme lasts for an hour every day. | T / F |
| 3 | Listeners can choose songs to be played for their friends. | T / F |
| 4 | Listeners' stories will be shared on the radio every other week. | T / F |



A2 Listen to the radio programme again and complete the notes below.

Hot Hits and Super Sounds

When is the programme?

At 12 noon every (1) _____

What is broadcast?

- (2) _____ as well as old catchy tunes
- Different types of music, from the blues to jazz, from pop to (3) _____
- Stories about (4) _____

How can listeners take part?

- Let the host know what they want to hear by getting in touch on (5) _____
- Share their personal musical journey and be invited to be (6) _____

B After listening to the radio programme, Jacky has found an article about his favourite band. Read the article and pay attention to its structure.



I remember getting ready for school one morning when the radio presenter announced that he was going to play the latest single by the Beatles. I rushed down the stairs as fast as I could to get nearer to the radio. This was 1965 and the whole country was in a state of “Beatlemania” ... and I was their biggest fan! I turned up the volume and stood staring at the radio, holding my breath and waiting for the first notes of the song.

It was definitely the Beatles. Paul McCartney’s voice was unmistakable but the sound was different. When the song had finished, I stood not knowing whether I liked it or not. However, this was not unusual. Different beats, tunes and a combination of different instruments meant that it took time for me to uncover the beauty of the song. Once that happened, I knew I would love the song forever. Yes, I was their biggest fan and I couldn’t wait to hear this song again and again until it became my favourite song from my favourite band.

During the 1960s, the Beatles were not just a band; they were a force for change. They exploded onto the music scene in 1962 as four young men with unique haircuts. They immediately grabbed the attention of young people and soon the youth of the country were being swept along on waves of joyous rock and roll music and the hope for a better future.

Today, I have in my collection every disc ever made by the Beatles. I truly love their music and enjoy looking at their musical journey from basic rock and roll, through their experimentation with more complicated and progressive sounds, and then back to the less complicated music of their final records. Whenever I listen to “She Loves You”, I am instantly taken back to my teenage years. I can picture my bedroom decorated with posters of the Fab Four smiling down at me and I can see myself riding my bicycle through country lanes singing “yeah, yeah, yeah” at the top of my voice. Yes, the Beatles’s music has accompanied me throughout my life. It has helped me look to the future with expectation and now it helps me reflect on my life with quiet satisfaction.

C In pairs, talk about your favourite singer or band. Use the following questions and expressions to help you.

- Who is your favourite singer or band?
- What do you like about the singer or band?
- What are your favourite songs by the singer or band? How do you feel when you listen to them?
- What are the highlights of the singer's or band's music career?
- Can you think of a memorable time when you listened to the singer's or band's songs? What was it like?

Expressions

Asking for further information

Could you tell me more about ...?

I wonder if you could say more about ...

I'd like to know more about ... Could you tell me something about that?

I'm really interested in ... Could you tell me a little bit more?

D Write an article about your favourite singer or band. Use your ideas from part C and the information in parts A and B to help you.

Planning your writing

• Learning about the structure

When writing an article about your favourite singer or band, you can follow the structure below:

- Give some basic information of your favourite singer or band.
- Introduce the features and influences of the singer's or band's music and explain why you like the singer or band.
- Describe an unforgettable memory related to the singer or band. This can also be put at the beginning of your writing.

• Learning about the language

Use words about emotions to tell readers how you feel. Adjectives expressing positive feelings include *amazed, delighted, joyous, overjoyed, cheerful, excited, satisfied, relieved, energetic, calm* and *peaceful*. You might use such words as *lonely, anxious, nervous, bored, depressed, frustrated, upset, worried* and *stressed* when you describe how the music helps you get rid of negative feelings.

Checking your writing

Remember to check your writing after you finish and exchange drafts between you and your partner. Pay attention to the following aspects:

☐ Punctuation

☐ Spelling

☐ Grammar

☐ Choice of words

☐ Style (formal/informal)

☐ Structure

Self-review

- What mistakes do you find in your writing?
- How can you correct them?

Peer review

- What suggestions does your partner give to improve your writing?
- How can you improve your writing?

Extended reading



Read the magazine article about the great classical musician Ludwig van Beethoven.

Beethoven: a remarkable life



On 7 May 1824, a crowd of music lovers streamed into a theatre in Vienna to hear the first-ever performance of the great Ludwig van Beethoven's *Symphony No. 9*. The crowd immediately recognized that they were listening to something truly special, and they broke into enthusiastic cheers at the end of the symphony. Beethoven, who was almost completely deaf at this point in his life, was unaware of the audience's response until one of the singers turned him around to face the crowd. Before him, he saw a sea of people all standing, clapping, and waving their hats and handkerchiefs to express their appreciation of his masterwork.

Symphony No. 9 was Beethoven's last major piece of music in a vast body of works written throughout his remarkable life. As a gifted child, Beethoven was pushed by his father to study music day and night. Not long after, he began to be appreciated for his piano performances. By the time he was a teenager, he had already enjoyed a reputation as a wonderful young musician. Many important figures in the music world, including the brilliant musician Mozart, started making predictions about Beethoven's extraordinary future. However, life took a sharp turn. In his late twenties, Beethoven suffered one of the worst possible twists for a musician: he started to lose his hearing.

The loss of his hearing deeply depressed Beethoven. He was so upset that, at first, he wanted to keep it a secret. In a letter to his brothers, he wrote, "... how could I possibly admit a weakness in the one sense which should be more perfect in

me than in others, a sense which I once possessed in the greatest perfection ...”
Even in his darkest moments, however, Beethoven never abandoned hope. Despite his hearing loss, he was determined to find a way to continue living a life full of music. He used a variety of hearing aids to try to increase the amount of sound
25 he could take in. When composing music at the piano, he would put one end of a pencil in his mouth and place the other end against the instrument so that he could feel the notes. Although Beethoven was able to continue composing music, it became increasingly difficult for him to perform in public. When Beethoven presented *Symphony No. 9* in Vienna in 1824, it was his first time on stage in over
30 ten years.

Since that day, Beethoven's *Symphony No. 9* has become one of the most famous and treasured pieces in the history of classical music. The first movement starts quietly, but all of a sudden the whole orchestra breaks into an energetic theme. You can soon feel the determination—a quality Beethoven understood well because of his
35 hearing difficulties—coursing through the music. The next two movements are full of desperate lows and uplifting highs which perhaps reflect both his suffering and his strong will to fight it. The music moves through technically difficult sections with ease, showing his genius as a composer. Finally, in the fourth movement, he connects all of the different variations into a joyful chorus.

40 As Beethoven's last great work, his *Symphony No. 9* was also a grand finale to his life—he died less than three years after the concert in Vienna, aged 56. For his amazing achievements and for his determination even in his darkest days, Beethoven is regarded as one of the most remarkable musicians who ever lived.

A In pairs, discuss the following questions.

- 1 What is the structure of the article?
- 2 What was the biggest problem Beethoven faced in his life? How did he try to overcome this problem?
- 3 How can you briefly introduce Beethoven's *Symphony No. 9* using the information in the article?

B What do you think makes a great musician? Make a list of the qualities and explain why they are important.

Tip

Identifying flashback in a text

In some texts, the events are not put exactly in time order; instead, an event that happened earlier is put in the middle of the main story, which is called flashback. You can tell you are reading a flashback when the story goes back to the past with a change of scene. There is usually a transitional sentence indicating the change.

Project

Making a profile of an English song

A As a class, discuss English songs you know and like. Then in groups, choose a song to research.

B As a group, research your chosen song. Use the ideas below to help you.

Song				
Background	Singer/Band	Lyrics	Style	Meaning

C As a group, put together your information to make your profile. Use the example below to help you. Then present your profile to the rest of the class and sing the song as a group.



Assessment

Answer the following questions to assess your performance. Then work in groups and exchange your answers with your partners.

- 1 In the exchange students' emails, what shows that music is a good way to learn about culture?
- 2 Did you have any difficulty when you wrote the article about your favourite singer or band? If yes, what was it?
- 3 How does the article about Beethoven's remarkable life inspire you during difficult times?
- 4 While doing the project of this unit, what contribution did you make to your group?
- 5 What new words have you learnt from this unit? List some of them. *
- 6 What grammar have you learnt from this unit? Make a sentence with the grammar. *
- 7 What tip have you learnt from this unit? Provide an example to show how it helps you with your learning.
- 8 How are you going to improve your overall performance? Make an action plan.

* Assess your learning of vocabulary and grammar by doing language practice on pages 63–64.

Further study



The Sound of Music is a musical drama film about how a family strengthen their love for each other through music. This long-lasting classic film is widely known around the world and its catchy songs are still well loved today. Watch it to find out more about this touching story.



Vie de Beethoven, a book by Romain Rolland, reveals a lifelike impression of Beethoven. Readers can get to know that Beethoven was a strong and pure man, and that despite all his sufferings, he never gave up and emerged as a conqueror. Read the English version of the book to learn more about the talented musician.



UNIT 3

The art of painting

Painting is silent poetry, and poetry is painting that speaks.

—Simonides of Ceos

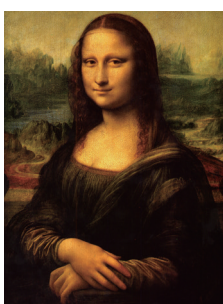


In this unit, you are going to:

- read a travel journal about a visit to an art museum;
- write instructions on how to make an unusual picture;
- read an essay on a famous Chinese painting;
- make a poster about a painter.

Welcome to the unit

The art of painting has a long history and there are different types of painting. Look at the paintings below and discuss the following questions in pairs.



Below is a list of some popular types of painting:

- Portrait painting
- Still life painting
- Landscape painting
- Cityscape painting
- Real-life painting
- History painting

- 1 Which type do you think each of the paintings belongs to? Why?
- 2 What famous painters and paintings do you know about?

1	3
2	4

Reading



Visiting museums is a very rewarding experience. The travel journal below is about a visit to an art museum. Before you read the travel journal, think about the following questions:

- What do you think the travel journal talks about according to the title and the pictures?
- Why do people visit art museums?



3 June

Paris, France

As a huge art fan, I knew exactly what I was looking forward to most about my trip to Paris: visiting the Musée d'Orsay. Housed in an old railway building, this
5 world-famous art museum features some of the best-known paintings from the Impressionist movement of the 19th century.

As I wandered through the Impressionist gallery, I appreciated masterpieces like *The Ballet Class* and *The Card Players*. Even though I had admired them hundreds of times on my computer screen, nothing could have prepared me for the wonder
10 I felt when I finally laid eyes on the real thing. While it was hard to pick a favourite painting out of so many amazing works, the artists who made the deepest impression on me were two of the greatest Impressionist painters, Claude Monet and Pierre-Auguste Renoir.

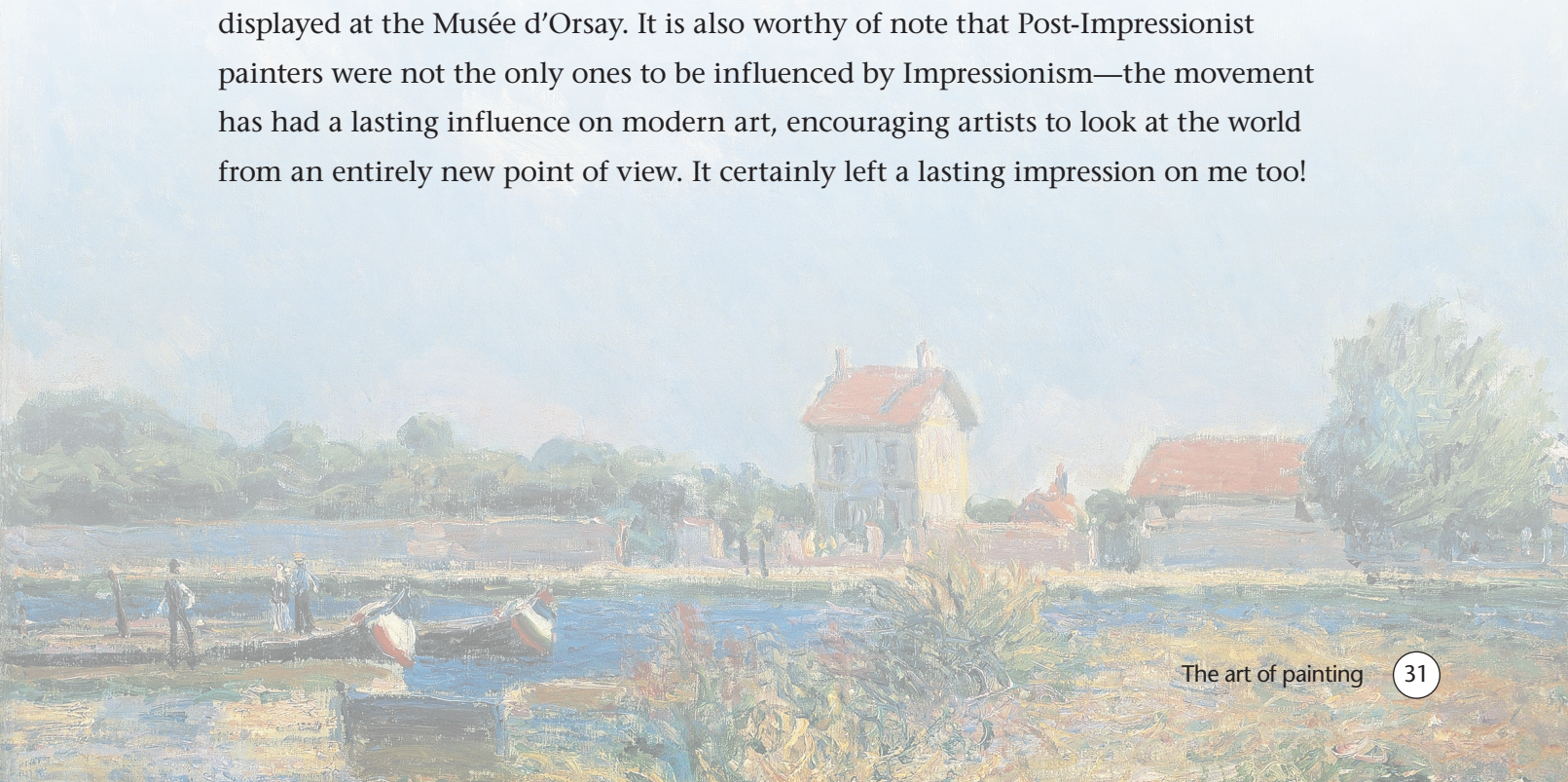
I could see from Monet's works that he was greatly inspired by nature. In the last
15 three decades of his life he painted mostly scenes from his garden. One of these scenes is shown in the famous piece *Blue Water Lilies*, which I studied for quite a while in the gallery. I couldn't believe it when I heard he did around 250 paintings

of the same water lily pond, all in different colours and styles. It is amazing that every time Monet studied this simple scene, he brought the pond's beauty to the canvas in a unique way.

Renoir, I noticed, preferred to paint scenes of everyday life. For me, the most interesting of his paintings is his 1876 masterpiece *Dance at Le Moulin de la Galette*, which shows life in a busy neighbourhood of Paris on a Sunday afternoon. When I saw it up close, I was struck by the small areas of light across the painting, and the way the soft edges of the figures seemed to mix together. There's so much going on, but so little clear detail. This effect makes the lively movement of the dance almost jump out at the viewer.

Although the paintings had very different settings, it was their similarities that stayed with me long after I left the Musée d'Orsay—similarities which can be seen throughout the Impressionists' paintings. Monet and Renoir, along with other like-minded artists, sought liberation from the rules of the old style. Everyday subject matter was the main focus of their works, as opposed to the history paintings that had traditionally dominated European art. They employed free brushwork and used colours to show the effect of light on things, creating paintings that were far less realistic than the works that came before. To me, these techniques are the essence of the Impressionist view of art. Impressionist artists did not try to paint every detail in a scene—just a brief “impression” they had at that moment, burning with vivid colours and light, before it disappeared.

The Impressionists' vision inspired a whole new generation of Post-Impressionist painters such as Vincent van Gogh and Paul Gauguin, whose works are also displayed at the Musée d'Orsay. It is also worthy of note that Post-Impressionist painters were not the only ones to be influenced by Impressionism—the movement has had a lasting influence on modern art, encouraging artists to look at the world from an entirely new point of view. It certainly left a lasting impression on me too!



A Understanding the text

A1 Read the travel journal and write down the main idea of each part in the chart below.

Para. 1	⇒	_____
Paras. 2–4	⇒	_____
Paras. 5–6	⇒	_____

A2 Read the travel journal again carefully and decide whether the following statements are true (**T**) or false (**F**). Note down the sentences in the travel journal that support the true statements and correct the false statements.

- 1 The author was most impressed by Monet and Renoir. T / F

- 2 Renoir's masterpiece *Dance at Le Moulin de la Galette* is very detailed. T / F

- 3 The Impressionists tried to paint extremely realistic paintings. T / F

- 4 The Impressionists showed the effect of light on things with colours. T / F

- 5 Van Gogh was influenced by Impressionism. T / F

A3 In pairs, discuss the following questions.

- 1 Which of the following do you think is most likely to be an Impressionist painting? Give your reasons.



- 2 If you were a tour guide of the Musée d'Orsay, how would you introduce the museum to the visitors?